

Introduction

Diagnosis of Rheumatoid arthritis. Indulgence in incompatible eatables and habits, lack of physical activity, or doing exercise after taking fatty eatables and those who have poor digestive capacity even normally also generate *āma* (improperly digested eatable) in the body. When a person of sedentary habits with a poor digestive faculty indulges in incompatible diet and regimen, or does physical exercise after taking fatty food the *āma* is formed. This *āma*, associating itself with *vāta*, moves quickly to the different seats of *kapha* in the body filling them and the *dhamanīs* (blood vessels) with waxy material. Thus the abnormal end product of digestion associated with *vāta*, *pitta* and *kapha* assuming different colours, blocks the tissue pores and passages with thick waxy material. It renders the patient weak in no time and produces a feeling of heaviness in the pericardial region. This substance named *āma* is the cause of so many distressing diseases. When provoked *āma* simultaneously afflicts the pelvic and shoulder, they girdle and make other joints of the body stiff. This condition has been identified as *āmavāta*. (MN. 25. 1-5)

Hetu of Āmavāta (Etiological factors of Āmavāta)

विरुद्धाहारचेष्टस्य मन्दाग्नेर्निश्चलस्य च ।
स्निग्धं भुक्तवतो ह्यन्नं व्यायामं कुर्वतस्तथा ॥
(M.Ni 24/1)

For the first time hetu of *Āmavāta* was first described by *Madhukoṣakara* in *Mādhava Nidāna* are as follows-

Disagreement dietetics and drinks; hindered activities or behaviour, slowness or inactive in the digestive mechanism. unchangeable or sedentary habits; consumption of sticky food followed by exercise.

Pūrvarūpa (Prodromal Symptoms)

The only text which describes the premonitory

signs and symptoms is *Vaṅgasena Samhitā* namely:- *Śirā rūja* (Cephalgia) and *Gātra rūja* (Bodyache).

Samprāpti of Āmavāta

वायुना प्रेरितो ह्यामः श्लेष्मस्थानं प्रधावति ।
तेनात्यर्थं विदग्धोऽसौ धमनीः प्रतिपद्यते ॥
वातपित्तकफैर्भूयो दूषितः सोऽन्नजो रसः ।
स्रोतोऽस्यभिष्यन्दयति नानावर्णोऽतिपिच्छिलः ॥
जनयत्याशु दौर्बल्यं गौरवं हृदयस्य च ।
व्याधीनामाश्रयो ह्येष आमसंज्ञोऽतिदारुणः ॥
युगपत्कुपितावन्तस्त्रिकसन्धिप्रवेशकौ ।
स्तब्धं च कुरुतो गात्रमामवातः स उच्यते ॥

(M.Ni 24/2-5)

Due to ingestion of the etiological factors, which mentioned earlier, disturbs the normal functions of *agni* as a result food not properly digested, yields immature *Rasa* in the *Āmāśaya* and this undergoes fermentation and/or putrefaction because of its retention for longer duration, manifests *Āma*. Then it is absorbed in the system and it is taken up by the aggravated and vitiated *Vāyu* specially to the *Kaphasthānās* mainly *Āmāśaya*, *Sandhi*, *Ūras*, *Kañṭha* etc. and the same undergoes in the above mentioned sites and enters the *Dhamani* by circulation with the help of *Vāta*. Here it amalgamates with the existing *Doṣās* and vitiated further in excess and produces distress in the body channels due to its excessive unctuous nature and some other different qualities of *Āmarasa*. This leads to general weakness and heaviness in the precordial region, and this *Āmarasa* is responsible for the genesis of symptom complex, that's why this disease is considered challenging and difficult to treat. So both *Āma* and *Vāta* aggravates simultaneously and enters *Koṣṭha*, *Trika* and *Sandhi* and ultimately leads to *Stabdhatā* in the body. This is called *Āmavāta*.

Nidān Sevana (Consumption of Etiological factors)



Aggravation of *Kapha doṣa*
 ↓
 Enters the *Āmāśaya*
 ↓
 Disturbs the *Agni*
 ↓
 Yields immature *Rasa* in the *Āmāśaya* i.e. *Āma*
 ↓
 Undergoes fermentation and/or putrefaction
 because of its retention for longer duration
 ↓
Āma absorbed in the system
 ↓
 It is taken up by the aggravated and vitiated *Vāyu*
 specially to the *Kaphasthānās* mainly *Āmāśaya*,
Sandhi, *Ūras*, *Kaṇṭha* etc.
 ↓
 Enters the *Dhamani* by circulation with the
 help of *Vāta*
 ↓
 Amalgamate with the existing *Doṣās* there
 ↓
 Vitiates further in excess and produces distress in
 the body channels due to its excessive unctuous
 nature and some other different qualities of
Āmarasa.
 ↓
 This leads to general weakness and heaviness in
 the precordial region
 ↓
Āmarasa is responsible for the genesis of
 symptom complex
 ↓
 That's why this disease is considered challenging
 and difficult to treat
 ↓
 So both *Āma* and *Vāta* aggravates
 simultaneously and enters *Koṣṭha*, *Trika* and
 ultimately leads to *Stabdhatā* in the body
 ↓
Āmavāta.

आमवात संप्राप्ति घटक (Samprāpti Ghaṭaka of *Āmavāta*)

Doṣa : *Vāta* → *Vyāna*, *Samāna*, *Prāṇa*
Pitta → *Pācaka*
Kapha → *Śleṣaka*

Dūṣya : *Dhātu* → *Rasa*, *Meda*, *Majjā*
Upadhātu → *Sirā*, *Snāyu*
Śārīrika Mala → *Puriṣa*
Dhātu Mala → *Kapha*
Agni : *Jaṭharāgni* and *Dhātavāgni*
Agniduṣṭi : *Mandāgni*
Āma : *Āgnijanya*
Srotas : *Annavaḥa*, *Rasavaḥa*,
Asthivaha
Srotoduṣṭi : *Saṅga*
Udbhavasthāna : *Āmāśaya*, *Pakvāśaya*
Sancārasthāna : *Annavaḥa srotas*, *Dhamani*,
Kaphasthāna
Adhiṣṭhāna : *Kaphasthāna* like *Sandhi*,
Āmāśaya etc.
Vyaktasthāna : *Kaphasthāna* i.e., *Sandhi*,
Āmāśaya, *Ūras* etc.
Svabhāva : *Kaṣṭasādhyā*
Roga Mārga : *Madhyama*

Cardinal Signs and Symptoms of *Āmavāta*

अङ्गमर्दोऽरुचिस्तृष्णा ह्यालस्यं गौरवं ज्वरः ।
 अपाकः शूनताऽङ्गानामामवातस्य लक्षणम् ॥
 (M.Ni 24/6)

General signs and symptoms of *Āmavāta* are
 bodyache, anorexia, thirst, heaviness, fever,
 indigestion and numbness

Signs and symptoms of advanced *Āmavāta*

स कष्टः सर्वरोगाणां यदा प्रकुपितो भवेत् ।
 हस्तपादशिरोगुल्फत्रिकजानूरुसन्धिषु ॥
 करोति सरुजं शोथं यत्र दोषः प्रपद्यते ।
 स देशो रुज्यतेऽत्यर्थं व्याविद्ध इव वृश्चिकैः ॥
 जनयेत्सोऽग्निदौर्बल्यं प्रसेकारुचिगौरवम् ।
 उत्साहहानिं वैरस्यं दाहं च बहुमूत्रताम् ॥
 कुक्षौ कङ्गिनतां शूलं तथा निद्राविपर्ययम् ।
 तृट्छर्दिभ्रममूर्च्छाश्च हृद्ग्रहं विड्विबद्धताम् ।
 जाड्यान्त्रकूजमानाहं कष्टाश्चानुपद्रवान् ॥
 (M.Ni 24/7-10)

Painful swelling of the joints i.e. hand, feet,
 ankle, knee, hip and spinal column, nature of pain
 is like that of scorpion sting, stiffness, hindered
 digestive mechanism, excessive salivation,
 anorexia, heaviness, lack of enthusiasm, distaste
 in the mouth, burning sensation, excessive

urination, hardness and pain in the abdomen, disturbed sleep, thirst, vertigo, fainting, stiffness in precordium, constipation, stiffness, intestinal sounds, distension of abdomen, severe difficulties with complications.

Viśiṣṭa Lakṣaṇās (special cardinal signs and symptoms)

पित्तात्सदाहरागं च सशूलं पवनानुगम् ।
स्तिमितं गुरुकण्डूं च कफदुष्टं तमादिशेत् ॥
(M.Ni 24/11)

Totally 7 types of *Āmavāta* mentioned according to dominancy of *doṣās* in *Mādhava Nidāna* & *Yogarātnākara*.

1. *Vātaja Āmavāta* - Characterised by agonizing pain in the affected parts.
2. *Pittaja Āmavāta* - Characterised by burning and redness of the affected joints.
3. *Ślaiṣmika Āmavāta* - Characterised by rigid, heaviness, itching of the affected joints.
4. *Vāta-Pittaja Āmavāta* - Combination of *vata* and *Pittaja Āmavata* signs & symptoms
5. *Pitta-Kaphaja Āmavāta* - Combination of signs & symptoms of *Pittaja* & *Kaphaja Āmavata*.
6. *Vāta-Kaphaja Āmavata* - Manifestation of both *Vataja* & *Kaphaja Āmavata* Symptoms
7. *Sannipātaja Āmavata* - Combination of all signs and symptoms of three *Doṣas* along with swelling all over the body.

Sādhyāsādhyatva (prognosis)

एकदोषानुगः साध्यो द्विदोषो याप्य उच्यते ।
सर्वदेहचरः शोथः कृच्छ्रः सान्निपातिकः ॥
(M.Ni 24/12)

Various authors like *Mādhava Nidāna*, *Vaṅgasena Samhitā*, *Bhāvaprakāśa*, *Yogarātnākara*, *Gadanigraha* and *Śabdakalpa druma* etc. have explained the prognosis of *āmavāta* are as follows :

Dominancy of single *doṣa* in *āmavāta* indicates disease become easily curable. Dominancy of two *doṣa* in *āmavāta* indicates manageable condition

and dominancy of all the three *doṣās* indicates difficult to cure.

उपशय/पथ्य (Upaśaya/Pathya)

A patient of *Āmavāta* who suffers morbid thirst should drink water which has been boiled along with *Pippalī*, *Pippalīmūla*, *Cavya*, *Citraka* and dried ginger. One should consume brinjal cooked in *Kānji* of *Sauvīra* and boiled fruits of *Tikta*. An *Āmavāta* patient's diet should include leaves of *Vāstuka*, leaves of *Neem*, leaves of *Punarnavā*, *Paṭola*, leaves of *Gokṣura*, leaves of *Varuṇa* and *Kāravellaka*, barley, *Kodrava*, old varieties of *Śālī* and *Ṣaṣṭhi* rice, meat of *Lāva* bird treated with buttermilk (*Takra*), pulse soup of *Kulattha* beans, peas as well as gram and the like. The patient should also take fomentation through warm sand particles packed in a piece of cotton. (B.R. 29/2-8)

The following measures are beneficial for a patient of *Āmavāta*: *Svedana* therapy of *Rūkṣa* type, *Laṅgana* (fasting), *Snehapāna*, *Basti* therapy, *Lepa* and the like. The patient should take the following eatables: old rice, *Kulattha* pulse, old liquor, meat soup of wild animals, buttermilk, *Varṣābhū*, *Eraṇḍa* oil, garlic, warm water, *Paṭola* leaves, *Kāravellaka*, brinjal, drumstick, ginger, cow urine and such herbs as *Gokṣura*, *Vṛiddhdāraka* and *Bhallātaka*. The bitter and sour edibles and those meals, which are easily digestible, are useful for the patient. (B.R. 29/232-234)

अनुपशय/अपथ्य (Anupaśaya/Apathya)

The following measures are harmful for a patient of *Āmavāta*: facing easterly winds, eating incompatible meals, holding the force of urine and stools, excessive walking and the like. The patient should avoid the following eatables: curd, buttermilk, fish, raw sugar, milk, *Upodikā* leaves, *Urada*, contaminated water and the like. (B.R. 29/235-236)

The *Abhiṣyandaka* eatables, the edibles that are heavy to digest and the food containing oily substances should be purposely avoided by the patient of *Āmavāta*. (B.R. 29/237).

MCQs

1. *Vyavidhha iva vrischikai* is the feature of which disease
 - a. *Amavata*
 - b. *Vatarakta*
 - c. *Udavarta*
 - d. *Urustambha*
2. *Bahumutrata* seen in
 - a. *Amavata Samanyalakshana*
 - b. *Pravridhha Amavata lakshana*
 - c. *Kaphaja Amavatalakshana*
 - d. *Vataja Amavatalakshana*
3. Prognosis of *Dwidoshaja Amavata*
 - a. *Sadya*
 - b. *Krichrasadya*
 - c. *Yapya*
 - d. *Anupakrama*
4. Which among the following is not the *Samanyalakshana* of *Amavata*
 - a. *Angamarda*
 - b. *Hrillasa*
 - c. *Shoonanga*
 - d. *Daha toda spurana paka*
5. जाड्यान्त्रकूजमानाहंकष्टांशान्यानुपद्रवान् is about
 - a. *Amavata Samanyalakshana*
 - b. *Pravridhha Amavatalakshana*
 - c. *Kaphaja Amavatalakshana*
 - d. *Gulmaasadyalakshana*
6. Which among the following is not the feature of *Kaphapradhana Amavata*
 - a. *Sthimita*
 - b. *Sopha*
 - c. *Guru*
 - d. *Kandu*

Answer

1.	a	2.	b	3.	c
4.	d	5.	b	6.	b